

Austria — Bundesheer General Service Overview

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ROLE	CATEGORY	EDUCATION	APTITUDE	FITNESS	MEDICAL	NOTES
Grundwehrdiener (Compulsory Service)	General Military	Pflichtschulabschluss (9 years compulsory schooling)	Basic assessment at Stellungskommission	Standard — assessed during Stellung (military registration)	Medical classification assigned at Stellung	Mandatory military service for Austrian male citizens; 6 months basic service; specialist training follows initial period
Berufssoldat (Professional Soldier — Enlisted)	Career Military	Pflichtschulabschluss minimum; additional qualifications improve opportunities	Aptitude and selection testing at recruiting centre	Standard to High depending on role	Medical suitability required	Career soldier pathway; wide range of specialisms available after basic training; contract-based service
Unteroffizier (NCO Pathway)	Leadership	Pflichtschulabschluss; Matura helpful for advancement	NCO selection and aptitude testing	Standard to High	Medical suitability required	Leadership pathway below officer level; specialist and leadership roles; professional development through Heeresunteroffiziersakademie
Offizier (Officer Pathway)	Officer	Matura (Abitur equivalent) or university degree	Officer selection and academic assessment	Standard to High	Medical suitability required	Officer entry through Theresianische Militärakademie (ThMilAk); degree-level education included; leadership and command focused

